



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christian Heritage School

School Website: <https://www.christianheritageschool.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Christian Heritage School TX 06611 presents a distinctly faith-centered educational orientation. Public materials show a clear emphasis on God-centered formation, partnership with families and churches, chapel and spiritual practices, and a mission framed around spiritual and academic excellence. Across several public postings, the school highlights virtue, character formation, God-given gifts, and biblical worldview as core aims, with programs that blend academics, arts, and service in a Christ-centered community. On the classical rubric, the school exhibits strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and a robust Parents & Community orientation, plus definite classical traces in Pedagogy and Curriculum, while Curricular specifics and upper-level Pedagogy show a mixed (Somewhat Classical) alignment rather than fully classical implementation.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Most robust elements: Religious/theological grounding, formation-focused goals, and strong parental/-community partnership.
- Areas for needle-moving improvement (Somewhat Classical categories): explicit articulation and integration of classic liberal arts content (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades; broader Great Books/Cultural Transmission messaging within the curriculum.
- What would move the needle sections below spell out concrete steps to reach fuller classical alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize partnership with parents and churches, biblically grounded aims, and center-placing of Christ in education. The school's mission explicitly states its role to partner with parents and churches "in fulfilling their God-given responsibilities to teach children that In (Christ) are hid all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge" and to provide "an education of spiritual and academic excellence" to serve God. - The school references chapel, retreats, and co-sponsored events as integral to student life, underscoring liturgical and communal spiritual practices. - Additional passages describe partnership with the local church and a vision of education in service to God, including examples of church engagement and prayerful support.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords drawn from the classical lexicon include: theology, liturgy/worship, prayer, Christ/God, sacred practice, and communal worship. CHS usage aligns with these through phrases such as "partner with parents and churches," "God-given responsibilities," "worship at chapel," and "biblically based education." The positive-term set includes these concepts (theology, liturgy, worship, prayer, wonder, virtue). - Negative signals (e.g., secular relativism, values clarification) are not evident in the public materials of CHS. The absence of negative indicators supports a Classical alignment in this category.

Why this rating - The materials foreground a transcendent, theologically integrated framework (God/Christ/the Word) and liturgical community life (chapel, church partnerships), fulfilling the basic expectations for Transcendental moral realism and Grounded Theology in the classical rubric. The explicit aim to center Christ and to form students within a sacred communal practice supports a CLASSICAL rating here.

What would move the needle (if applicable) - Not required for CLASSICAL. However, to deepen alignment, explicit statements tying virtues (truth, goodness, beauty) to lived classroom practices could further strengthen the transcendental grounding in everyday curriculum.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - CHS frames education as formation rather than mere information, with explicit aims of forming character and serving God. The mission emphasizes “formation,” “spiritual and academic excellence,” and the development of human capacity (virtue and wisdom) in a God-centered frame. - Statements about partnering with families to raise children in a biblically rooted environment demonstrate a formation-oriented telos beyond vocational training. Additionally, posts emphasize character and leadership development (e.g., students growing in confidence and character through clubs and activities). - Language around serving God and stewarding God-given gifts signals a teleology oriented toward virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing rather than purely labor-market outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords drawn from the classical lexicon include: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, and human flourishing. CHS materials repeatedly emphasize forming students to live virtuous, God-centered lives and to pursue excellence beyond mere information. - Negative signals (e.g., workforce-orientation or job-prep emphasis) are not evident in the public materials; CHS does not foreground a technocratic, career-prep narrative.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and virtue in a transcendent frame, aligning with Classical aims of forming the whole person toward truth, goodness, and beauty rather than solely toward job-readiness. This supports CLASSICAL in this category.

What would move the needle - To move from CLASSICAL toward stronger, explicit alignment, the school could explicitly articulate the telos as formation via a clear statement of virtue ethics and connect that telos to a public articulation of Great Books and liberal-arts aims in the curriculum (e.g., “paideia of the Lord” language, as seen in related classical education literature). In addition, naming the Great Conversation and its curricular role would strengthen the alignment.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials reveal engagement with literature and history through classroom projects and reading, such as Heritage Fair activities that incorporate social studies, writing, and reading; and reading selections like *Letters From Rifka* that embed historical and cultural inquiry. This indicates some liberal-arts sensibilities and an integrated approach to history and literature. - The school’s extracurriculars (Math Olympiad, Spelling Bee, Debate Club) emphasize reasoning, memory, and rhetoric, showing an engagement with classic scholarly skills, even if not framed as a formal liberal-arts sequence. - Public materials also highlight arts programs (instrumental, vocal, theater) that align with a holistic, integrated education, which can complement a classical flavor when combined with reading and history across the curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the classical curriculum lexicon include: Great Books, primary sources, classics, liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, history study across the curriculum, and the Great Conversation. In CHS public materials, explicit references to “Great Books” are not consistently named, but there are explicit indications of classic-reading-like elements (e.g., *Letters From Rifka* as a canonical historical-literary piece) and integrated humanities projects. This yields partial alignment with the positive set, particularly around integrated history-literature projects and classical reading experiences. - Negative signals include any strong emphasis on project-based learning as the sole or primary method (a potential tension with strictly classical schooling that emphasizes the liberal arts canon and the Great Books). CHS does show extensive project-based activities at times (Heritage Fair, projects), which introduces some non-classical learning modes. This mixture is reflected in the presence of both traditional reading/history activities and project-based activities.

Why this rating - The presence of integrated humanities projects and historical-literary connections points toward classical sensibilities, but the explicit, codified Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books

program, and explicit “Great Conversation” framing are not consistently named in CHS’s public-facing materials. Thus, the category sits between classical and non-classical, i.e., SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Explicitly name and codify liberal-arts elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as core curricular strands, and articulate a Great Books/Great Conversation framework within the curriculum. Publish a public curriculum map that shows sequence from grammar to logic to rhetoric, and outline required Great Books readings (with canonical authors) across grades. Integrate explicit history across the curriculum and reference to Western civilization as part of a “cultural transmission” aim.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a range of instructional approaches that mix contemplative elements with active, discussion-based activities. There are mentions of debate and public-speaking opportunities (e.g., Debate Club for 4th–5th grade) and upper-level rhetoric training. This aligns with some classical pedagogy (Socratic discussion, seminars, rhetorical training) but is not uniformly described as the dominant method across grade levels. - There are explicit signs of contemplative/recollective practices (memory work, singing, and classroom routines) in lower grades that resemble scholé-like approaches, though not always described as such in public materials. - The lower-grade emphasis on singing, memory work, and regular review is reflected in CHS blog posts about student experiences and classical-mounding activities.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive pedagogy keywords from the classical lexicon include: Socratic seminar, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, scholé days, contemplation, wonder, and seminars. CHS publicly references debate and public-speaking opportunities (positive for rhetoric-based training) and mentions memory and recitation-style elements in lower grades, as seen in the descriptions of various clubs and classroom activities. - Negative signals include over-emphasis on experiential learning, project-based-only, student-directed, or constructivist methods. CHS’s public materials show a blend of project activities (e.g., Heritage Fair and clubs) alongside more traditional, teacher-led or structured activities, indicating a mixed pedagogy rather than a purely classical mode. This aligns with the presence of both classical and non-classical elements.

Why this rating - The presence of debate clubs and rhetoric-focused opportunities, plus lower-grade memory/recitation-like practices, demonstrates a partial classical pedagogy. However, the evident incorporation of project-based and club-driven activities without a consistent, fully codified Socratic/seminar framework across the upper grades places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Publicly articulate a tiered pedagogy that centers Socratic seminars and classical pedagogy in middle/high school, with a documented lower-school pathway that uses memory, chant, and recitation in a consistent, routine way. Publish a classroom-by-classroom pedagogy map showing the role of classic questions, seminar formats, and public speaking as core routines in every grade.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as mentors who model virtue and knowledge, with the credentialed leadership in place (e.g., Beth Maree as Lower School Principal) and department chairs in arts and other disciplines, suggesting a structured, professional faculty. The faculty are presented as part of a living curriculum (e.g., the departmental leadership and publicly highlighted teachers). - Public materials emphasize long-term relationships, mentorship, and role-modeling as core aspects of the faculty, aligning with the classical conception of the faculty as a “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher” guiding students. The Arts department listing and teacher profiles contribute to this portrayal. - There are explicit references to teachers’ roles in shaping character and forming students, aligning with the classical expectation of virtuous, knowledgeable mentors.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the classical faculty lexicon include: model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentors, and character formation. CHS materials present teachers in clearly mentorship-oriented terms and as key figures in student development, which aligns with these positive indicators. - Negative signals about faculty (e.g., overly jargon-y, certification-driven) are not evident in the public materials; rather, the emphasis is on mentorship and

virtuous leadership. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials portray a faculty whose roles center on mentorship, character formation, and living the curriculum, consistent with classical faculty expectations. The presence of named faculty leadership and department chairs strengthens this alignment.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly states a partnership with parents and churches, viewing parents as co-educators and integrally involved in the formation of their children. The mission emphasizes support for families and collaboration with the church, reflecting the classical emphasis on family and community in education. - Public materials show active parent involvement and multiple opportunities for families (home and church partnerships, parent events, tours, and formation resources). The CHS blog and community pages highlight family engagement, community events, and a welcoming campus for visits.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the Six Elements corpus include: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, family involvement, home-centered learning, parent participation, and school-parent synergy. CHS materials explicitly articulate parents as co-educators and emphasize family involvement and Church partnerships, which aligns with these positive indicators. - Negative indicators such as consumer language or minimal parent involvement are not present in CHS public materials; rather, there is an explicit focus on partnership and parental engagement. This reinforces CLASSICAL alignment for this category.

Why this rating - CHS presents a robust model of parent-school partnership and a welcoming community ethos, including open campus and family involvement in school life, which aligns strongly with the classical expectations for Parents & Community.

What would move the needle - To move further toward the strongest possible Classical alignment, CHS could publish a formal, public-facing Parent Formation program with schedules, book studies, and structured family-education events explicitly tied to classical education principles (e.g., readings on virtue formation, classical pedagogy theory, and family catechesis).

Aggregate Assessment

- CLASSICAL across most categories, with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy.
- Overall, the school demonstrates a classical orientation through its religious/theological foundations, formation-driven goals, faculty mentorship, and strong family/community partnerships, with room to deepen explicit liberal-arts curriculum articulation and fully codified classical pedagogy.

What Would Move the Needle

- Curriculum (Element 3)
- Publish a formal Liberal Arts map: grammar, logic, rhetoric pathway by grade, including explicit Great Books readings and a public “Great Conversation” framework.
- Integrate Western civilization and classical texts as core reading across grades, with a publicly available curriculum grid.
- Pedagogy (Element 4)
- Publicly codify a K–12 progression of Socratic/seminar pedagogy, with grade-specific formats (lower grades memory/recitation; middle/high school seminars and rhetoric/declamation opportunities).
- Minimize non-classical project-based approaches as the sole method, while clearly articulating a balanced approach that preserves contemplation, memory work, and seminar-style learning.
- Recruitment and Public Communication
- Strengthen explicit articulation of the classical telos (formation through liberal arts) in all marketing materials, with a public statement linking mission, curriculum, and pedagogy to classical education principles.
- Community and Family Formation

- Expand a structured Parent Formation program (book studies, lectures, discussion groups) that explicitly ties familial formation to classical education values and practices.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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